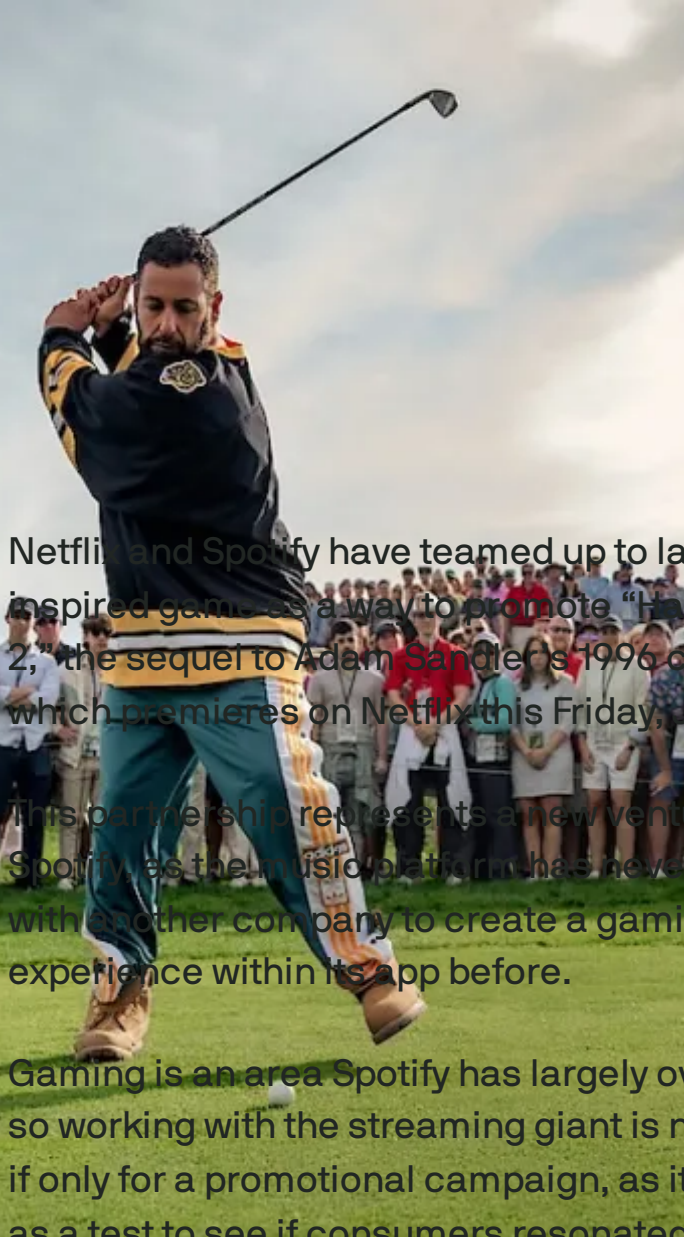


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Spotify takes a swing at gaming with a mini golf game ahead of 'Happy Gilmore 2' release

A large photograph of Adam Sandler in a golf swing, wearing a black and yellow jacket and blue pants, with a crowd in the background.

Netflix and Spotify have teamed up to launch a golf-inspired game as a way to promote “Happy Gilmore 2,” the sequel to Adam Sandler’s 1996 comedy film, which premieres on Netflix this Friday, July 25.

This partnership represents a new venture for Spotify, as the music platform has never teamed up with another company to create a gaming experience within its app before.

Gaming is an area Spotify has largely overlooked, so working with the streaming giant is notable, even if only for a promotional campaign, as it could serve as a test to see if consumers resonated with the experience. Since the game is tied to a beloved cult classic, it also presents a unique opportunity to boost engagement.

Spotify says it developed the game in partnership with MiK Studio.

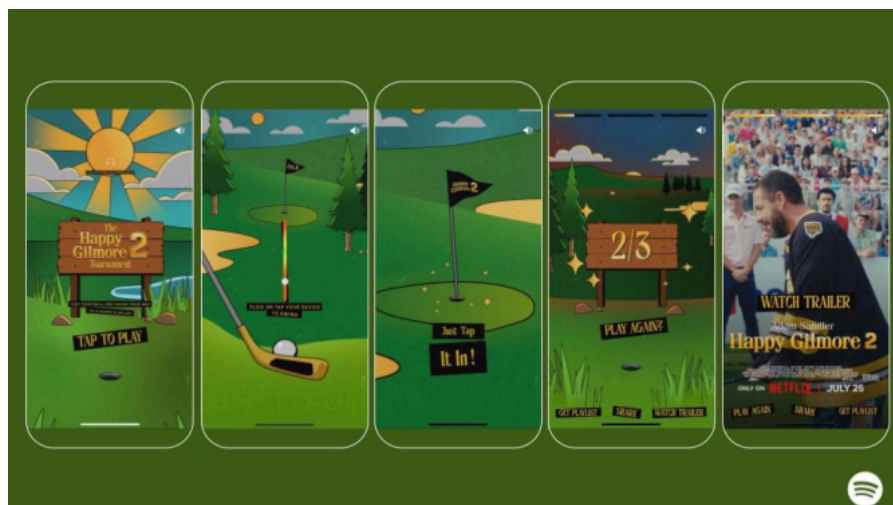


IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

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The new mini-game, titled Happy Gilmore 2 Tournament, is available exclusively within the Spotify app. To play, users must perfect their golf swing by tapping on their device as they aim to complete all three holes.

The game also offers a unique audiovisual experience, featuring audio clips from the movie when users complete each round, along with a personalized playlist of “happy” tracks curated specifically for the user. Players can also discover Easter eggs, such as Happy’s boots, his signature hockey stick, and an alligator.

At the end of the experience, users can watch the official “Happy Gilmore 2” trailer and share their personalized playlist and final score on social media.

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While this is the first time Spotify has worked with another company to develop a gaming experience, it’s worth noting that Spotify [previously launched](#) a hidden game on its platform as more of an Easter

egg. That game, released in 2023, was called Eat
This Playlist and was a variation of the classic
Snake arcade game where players control a
growing snake and avoid obstacles.

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Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at
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Spotify partners with Netflix to curate a personalized ‘Stranger Things’ playlist for fans

Lauren Forristal

10:38 AM PDT · July 1, 2022

Upside Down Playlist

IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

Which song will save you from Vecna? In partnership with [Netflix](#), [Spotify](#) has launched a personalized “Stranger Things” playlist dedicated to Season 4 Volume 2, which premieres this Friday, July 1. [The Upside Down playlist](#), as it’s called, blends music from a listener’s own selection with a handful of “Stranger Things” classics from the newest season.

“Stranger Things” already demonstrated its ability to influence the Spotify charts and now the companies are doubling down on consumer interest in the popular series to drive engagement.

Netflix’s “Stranger Things” ushered in a wave of ’80s nostalgia when the character Max Mayfield (Sadie Sink) manages to escape from Vecna (Jamie Campbell Bower) once her friends play her favorite song, “Running Up That Hill” by Kate Bush. Following the Season 4 premiere, the song reached No. 1 on iTunes. On May 30, it was streamed on Spotify by

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over 8,700% globally and 9,900% in the U.S, [per the company](#).

wanna know what songs would save YOU from Vecna? head to your Upside Down Playlist on [@Spotify](#) to find out

 the first Song on the list = your savior song 

[<https://t.co/rZ10wCJ6tA>]
pic.twitter.com/N3KOU3ohSK

— Stranger Things (@Stranger_Things) [June 29, 2022](#)

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As for the newly released curated playlist, it is a personalized experience for the listener and selects a top song that will be their “savior song” to help them escape from Vecna’s grasp. The collection updates automatically every day and will feature some of the top songs from the “Stranger Things” soundtrack, like “Rock You Like a Hurricane,” “Should I Stay or Should I Go” and

“Running Up That Hill “ (of course), while also mixing in the users’ own favorite tunes.

There will also be Easter eggs to enhance the experience further.

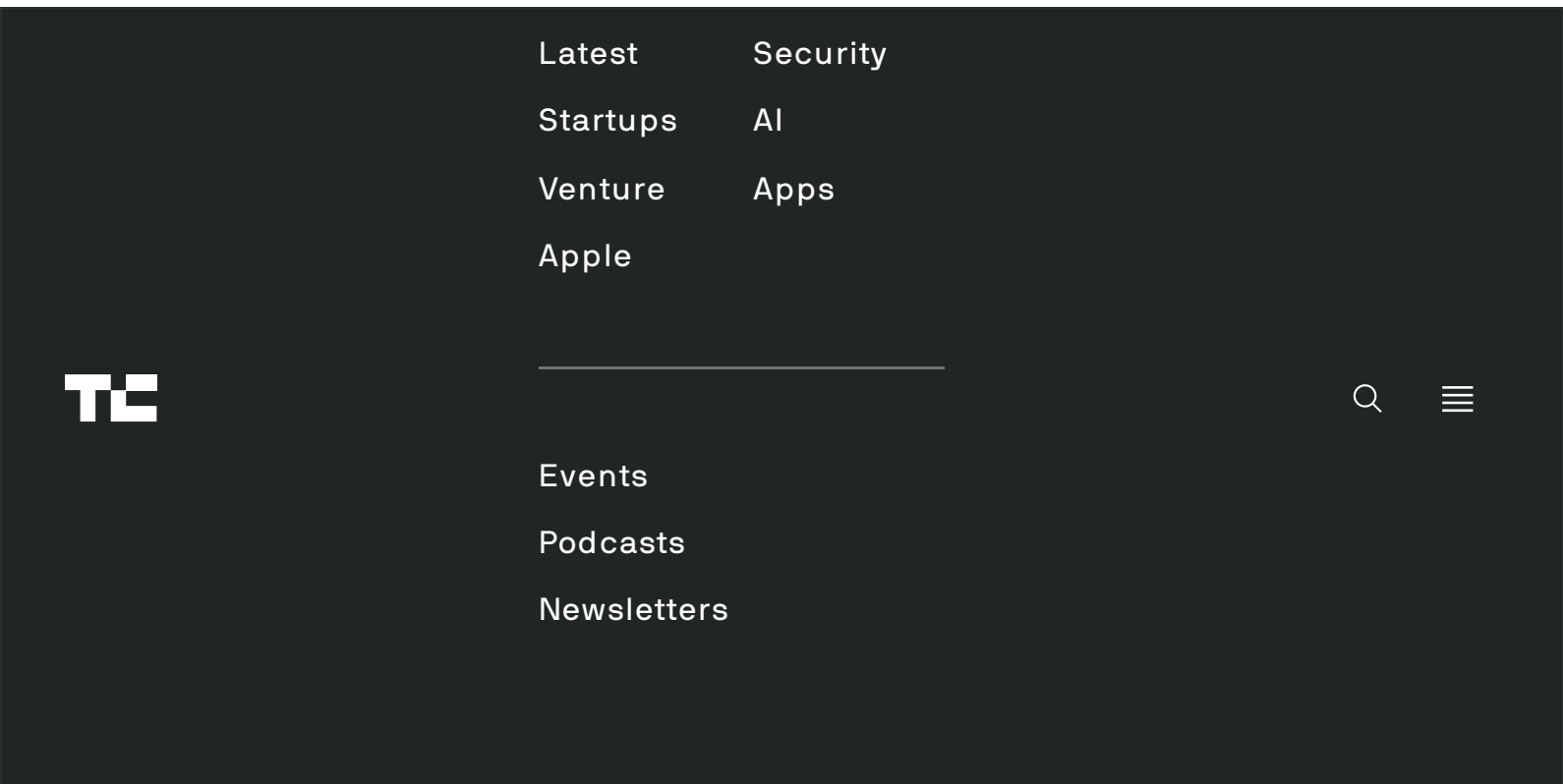


IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

In addition to the Upside Down playlist, Spotify has its “Stranger Things” official playlist, which has more than 969,000 followers and is the most followed playlist on the [Netflix Hub](#), according to Spotify.

On May 30, streams increased by more than 1,700% globally. Currently, the playlist features “Psycho Killer,” “I Was a Teenage Werewolf” and more. On July 1, Spotify will add all the latest sounds from

Season 4, Volume 2, to the “Stranger Things” official playlist.

Also, fans can go to Spotify’s Throwback Thursday playlist, where Caleb McLaughlin, who plays Lucas in the show, will pick some of his favorite ’80s jams.

This year, Netflix has heavily promoted the popular series and hopes that it can save the company from collapsing. Recently, the company has had an array of struggles, including [layoffs](#) of over 400 [employees](#) and a substantial loss of [200,000 subscribers](#) in the first quarter of 2022.

Over the past few months, Netflix has announced [an in-person experience](#) in Brooklyn, New York, along with [custom Reddit avatars](#), a Domino’s pizza app, Dorito packaging and more.

The company has also partnered with watch party platform [Scener](#) to bring viewers a worldwide watch party event on the night of the premiere. The event kicked off on June 30, at 11:15 p.m. PST or July 1 at 2:15 a.m. EST. There was a Q&A starring actors from the show as well as Netflix Geeked host Terri Schwartz. The second Q&A started at 1:15 a.m. PST or 4:15 a.m. EST.

Cast members that made an appearance include actors Brett Gelman (Murray), David Harbour (Jim Hopper), Jamie Campbell Bower (Henry Creel/Vecna) and Joseph Quinn (Eddie Munson).

Thousands of fans virtually screened the last two episodes of the season, saw real-time reactions from stars and connected with other fans over Scener’s live chat messenger. In total, the final two episodes of “Stranger Things” is four hours long. Scener told TechCrunch that 32,000 people [registered](#) for the event.

Reddit partners with Netflix to give Redditors ‘Stranger Things’ custom avatars



The social network Reddit unveiled new custom avatars inspired by Netflix’s “Stranger Things” characters ahead of the anticipated season four premiere this Friday, May 27. This is the first partnership

between Reddit and Netflix, and the limited-time avatars will be available until August. Redditors can now update their avatar to become the Demogorgon (which looks

[Continue](#)

‘Stranger Things’ fans can explore the Upside Down in new NYC experience



Hawkins comes to New York City on May 7 in a new “Stranger Things: Experience,” via a partnership with Netflix and Fever. Developed exclusively with the show’s creators, guests are sent

“into a parallel universe where they must unlock their secret powers to face the gauntlet of lurking terrors and help save the town,” according ... [Continue reading](#)

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Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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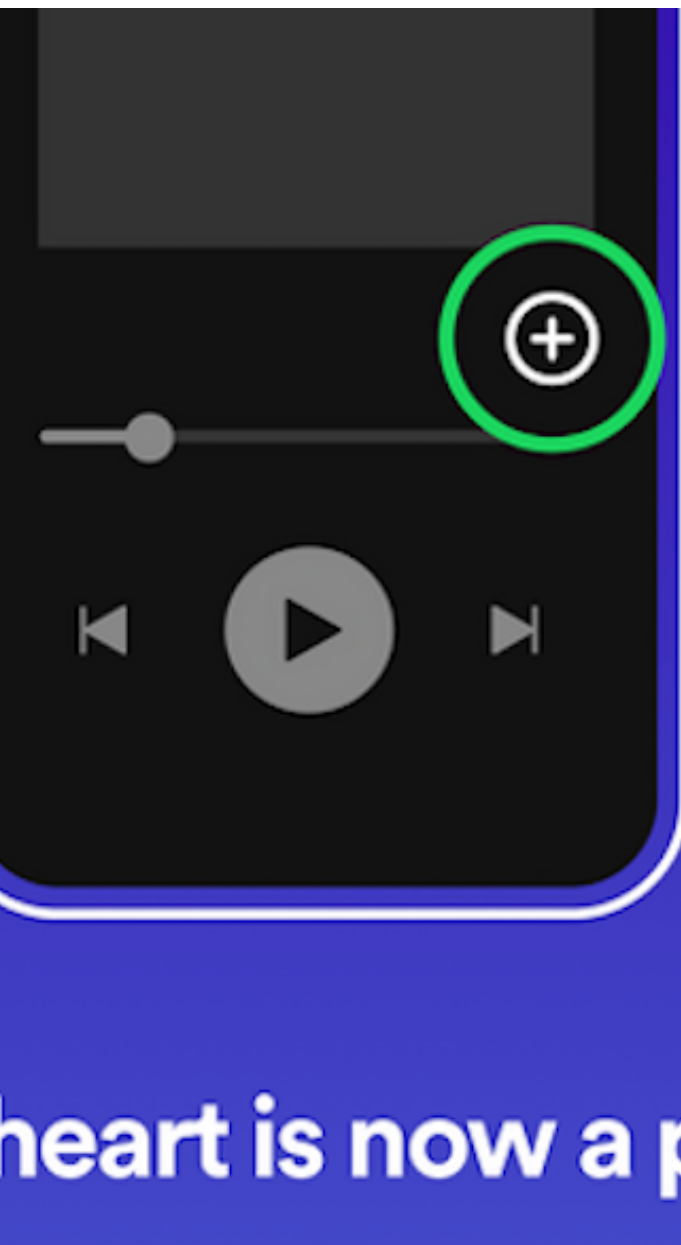


IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

APPS



Spotify kills its heart button to be replaced with a ‘plus’ sign

Lauren Forristal — 9:40 AM PST · February 27, 2023

Spotify [announced](#) today that it is consolidating the heart and the “Add to playlist” icons into a single plus button, allowing users to save all songs, albums, playlists, audiobooks, podcasts or episodes to their library with one tap.

To add a song to “Liked Songs,” users tap the plus button located on the right-hand side in the “Now Playing View.” After tapping on it, the icon will

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The Browser Company launches a \$20 monthly subscription for its AI-powered browser

change to a green checkmark to let the user know that it's been saved to the list. Then, if users want to add the song to another playlist, they can tap the plus icon again. Users can also select the new button on podcast episodes and add them to "Your Episodes."

Starting today, the new icon is rolling out worldwide on iOS and Android devices. It will become available to all Spotify users in the coming weeks. Some users already have the icon as Spotify has been [testing](#) the change since last year.

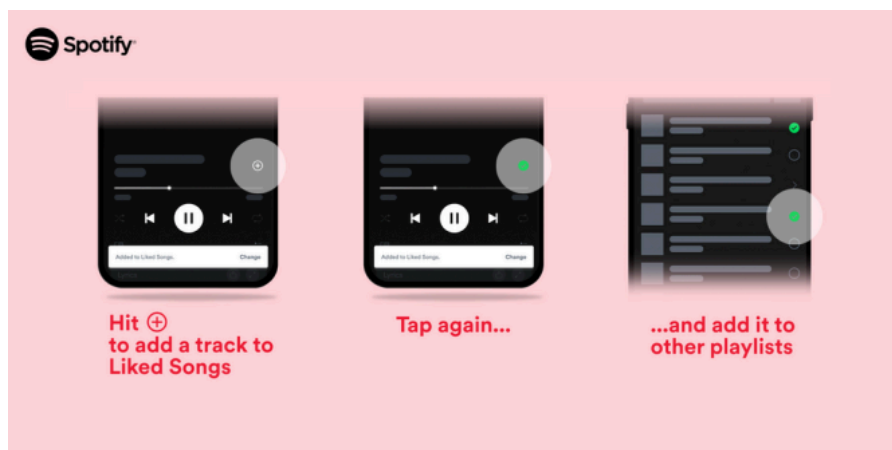


IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

Although it's a minor change, it might be hard for some users to get used to. A heart icon is widely used across many popular apps, including Spotify competitors like Apple Music as well as social media platforms like Twitter, TikTok and Instagram. In fact, [Twitter](#) changed its star-shaped favorite/like button to a heart in 2015 since the heart is a more universal symbol.

However, Spotify is convinced that the new plus button will help users save time since it gives them the ability to add to multiple playlists at once. During testing of the feature, Spotify said users were more likely to listen to the favorited track again after it was saved.

In recent months, Spotify has launched many ways to try and improve the user experience. For instance, last week, the music streaming service

Ivan Mehta - 2 hours ago

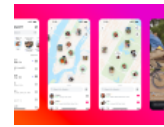
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Aisha Malik - 14 hours ago

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Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'

Aisha Malik - 18 hours ago



rolled out “[DJ](#),” a new AI feature that gives users a curated selection of music alongside AI-powered spoken commentary about their favorite songs and artists. The new feature is still in beta and is only available in English for paid subscribers in the United States and Canada.

Earlier this month, Spotify announced an “[Exclude from your taste profile](#)” feature that lets users dictate which playlists are excluded from their personalized recommendations.

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Also, the company [launched](#) a new Home experience over the summer where “Music” and “Podcasts & Shows” are separate feeds.

Spotify launches ‘DJ,’ a new feature offering personalized music with AI-powered commentary



Ahead of Spotify’s upcoming Stream On event, where the company is expected to announce a redesigned home feed and other updates, the company today launched a new AI feature called “DJ” to better personalize the music listening experience for its users. Similar to a radio DJ, Spotify’s DJ feature will deliver a curated selection of ... [Continue reading](#)

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